

Board: 2
Dealer: **South**

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 7 4
 ♥ 6 2
 ♦ J 10
 ♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ K 10

♦ K Q 8 6 5

♣ Q 8 7



♠ K 9 6 5 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 9 3

♣ 5 3

♠ A

♥ A Q J 7 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K J 4

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

How do you start this action? [Bid 1H] You open 1♥ and partner responds 2♦. What do you rebid? Partner's 2 over 1 bid sets up a game force. You have a good-looking hand, but you need to find a trump suit before showing extra strength, so she bids just 2♥. You are in a game forcing auction, so partner won't pass you. Partner now jumps to 4♥. What do you do now?

Partner's jump to 4♥ is Fast Arrival - showing a minimum game forcing hand. Even though we have extra values, this won't be enough for slam opposite 13 or so points.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ J
 ♥ K Q J 7 5 3
 ♦ 4 3 2
 ♣ Q 5 4

♠ 10
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ A J 10 8
 ♣ A 10 9 3 2

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♠ A Q 8 6 2
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ K 6 5
 ♣ K 8 7

♠ K 9 7 5 4 3
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ Q 9 7
 ♣ J 6

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♥			
All Pass			

East opens 1 ♠. You have 11 points, enough to respond 2 ♥ in standard bidding, but not when using 2/1. So we use the forcing 1NT. East rebids 2 ♣. This only promises 3 clubs, so is really just there so we can better describe our hand with our second bid. What do we bid now?

Now we can bid 2H, and it shows 6+ ♥s and only 6-10 points. East was forced to reply to 1NT, but he is not forced to bid again. With his minimum hand and a tolerance for partner's suit he just passes and the partnership ends up in a reasonable contract. This hand demonstrates one of the benefits of Forcing 1NT. In standard bidding West's first response would be 2 ♥, and East would have to bid again, probably 2NT. The partnership might go even higher but in any case would probably not reach a good contract.